

# Fresh and salt water

Earth is often called the blue planet because 75 per cent of its surface is covered in water. Most of the Earth's water is salt water in the oceans. Less than one per cent of all the water on Earth is fresh.



## The hydrosphere

The hydrosphere is the name for all the water on Earth. It includes oceans, rivers, and lakes. It also includes water that is frozen, such as icebergs.



## Water for life

All animals – and most other living things – must have water to survive. In mammals, including humans, water is part of the blood and of organs such as the skin and brain. There is water in every cell in your body!

## Freshwater sources

People get fresh water from different sources on Earth's surface, including rivers, streams, lakes, and reservoirs.



**Rivers and streams** flow from mountains down to the oceans.



**Lakes** are natural dips in the Earth where water collects.



**Reservoirs** are man-made lakes that are built to store water.

## Trapped in ice

Less than 33 per cent of fresh water is usable by humans. The rest is frozen in glaciers or icebergs (below), or as huge sheets of ice at the North and South poles.

